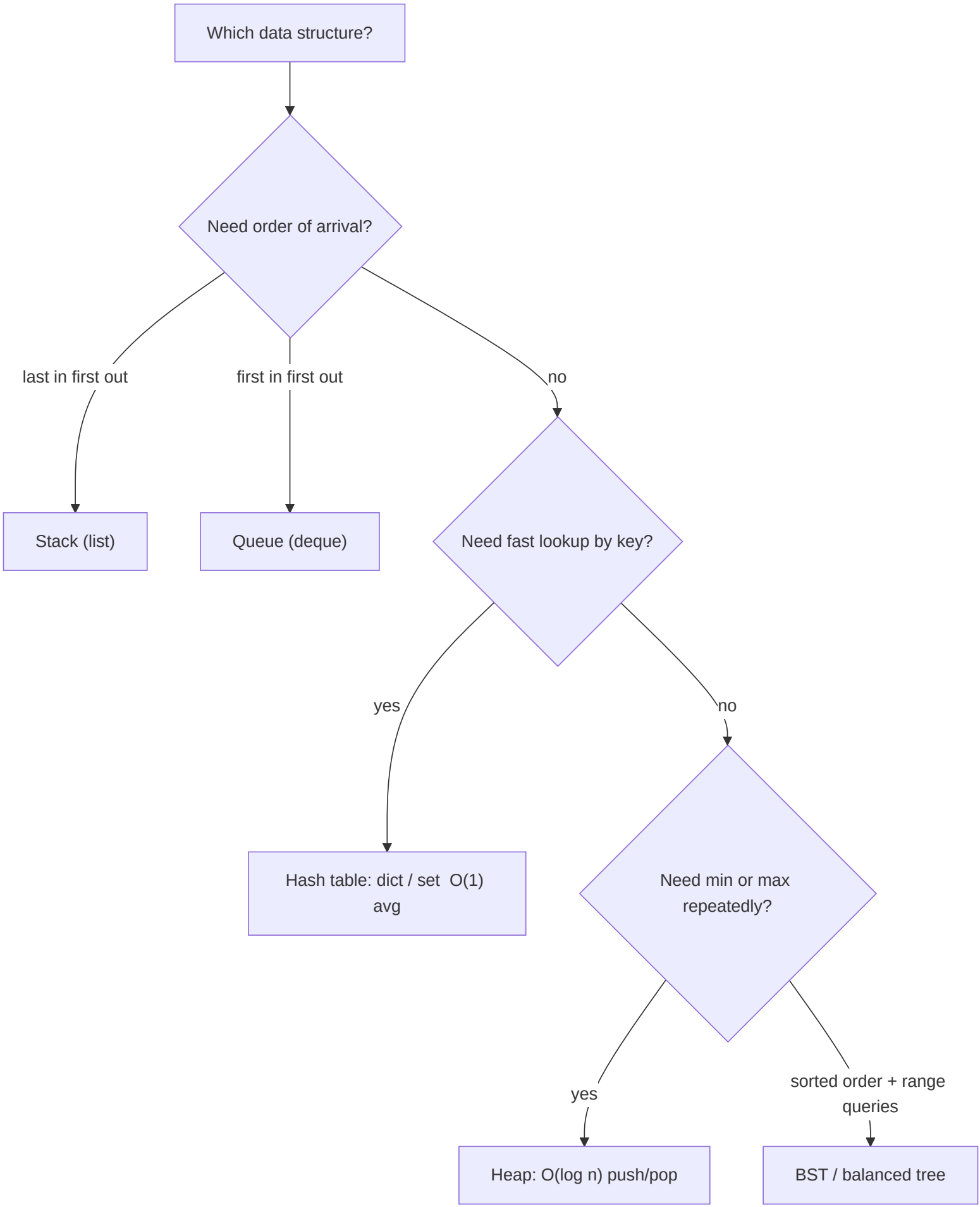
Which data structure?
Need order of arrival?
last in first out
first in first out
no
Stack (list)
Queue (deque)
Need fast lookup by key?
yes
no
Hash table: dict / set O(1) avg
Need min or max repeatedly?
yes
sorted order + range queries
Heap: O(log n) push/pop
BST / balanced tree